



Performance review phrases for job knowledge: 24 examples

Last checked 5 October 2026. Fill in the [BRACKETS] with your own facts.

Exceeds what the role needs

Knows [TOPIC] well and explains it plainly to colleagues: for example, [EXAMPLE].

Keeps up with changes in [FIELD] and applies them to [WORK]: for example, [EXAMPLE].

Finds the cause of problems with [SYSTEM] without help: for example, [EXAMPLE].

Is the person others ask about [TOPIC]. [NAME OR TEAM] has [RESULT] because of that.

Wrote down how [PROCESS] works so others can use it: [DOCUMENT].

Trained [NAME] on [TOPIC], and they now do [TASK] alone.

Meets what the role needs

Knows the main parts of [ROLE] and does them without close supervision: [EXAMPLE].

Asks good questions when a topic is new: [EXAMPLE].

Applies [PROCESS] correctly and checks their work before sending it: [EXAMPLE].

Has learned [TOOL] well enough to do [TASK] alone.

Knows when to ask for help and does so early: [EXAMPLE].

Follows the written steps for [PROCESS] and flags where they do not match what happens.

Below what the role needs

Needs more time with [TOPIC] before working alone. I would like us to agree a plan by [DATE].

Has not yet learned [TOOL]. This slowed [TASK] on [DATE]. I would like [TRAINING OR TASK] by [DATE].

Mixes up [TWO THINGS] on some tasks: [EXAMPLE]. A short guide may help.

Asks for the same answer about [TOPIC] more than once. I would like them to write it down so it sticks.

Does not yet explain [TOPIC] to others. I would like one short walk-through by [DATE].

Is unsure about [AREA] and tends to wait for help. I would like them to try first and then ask.

By situation: new hire, long-serving, changing role, remote

New hire

New to [ROLE]: has learned [TOPICS] in [NUMBER] weeks. The next topic is [TOPIC].

Long in the role

Long in the role: strong on [TOPIC]. I would like them to learn [NEW TOPIC] this year.

Changing role

Changing role: has picked up [TOPIC] quickly. The gap is [TOPIC].

Remote

Remote: finds answers in the team's documents before asking, and adds to them: [EXAMPLE].

Covering for someone

Covered for [NAME] on [TOPIC] and kept [WORK] on track: [EXAMPLE].

A course or certificate

Passed [CERTIFICATE / COURSE] on [DATE] and used it on [WORK].

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